

1 SMRITI MANDHANA **42.3** [33.4]



4 DEEPTI SHARMA **8** [7.6]



5 SNEH RANA **2.1** [NA]



1 NEERAJ CHOPRA *(Athletics)* **39.1** [41.5]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 sportsperson (male)?



2 SUNIL CHHETRI *(Football)* **17.2** [13.4]



3 D. GUKESH *(Chess)* **12.2** [NA]



4 HARMANPREET SINGH *(Hockey)* **5.2** [7.4]



5 CHIRAG SHETTY and SATWIKSAIRAJ RANKIREDDY *(Badminton)* **3.6** [3.9]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 female sportsperson?



2 MANU BHAKER *(Shooting)* **9.7** [12.3]



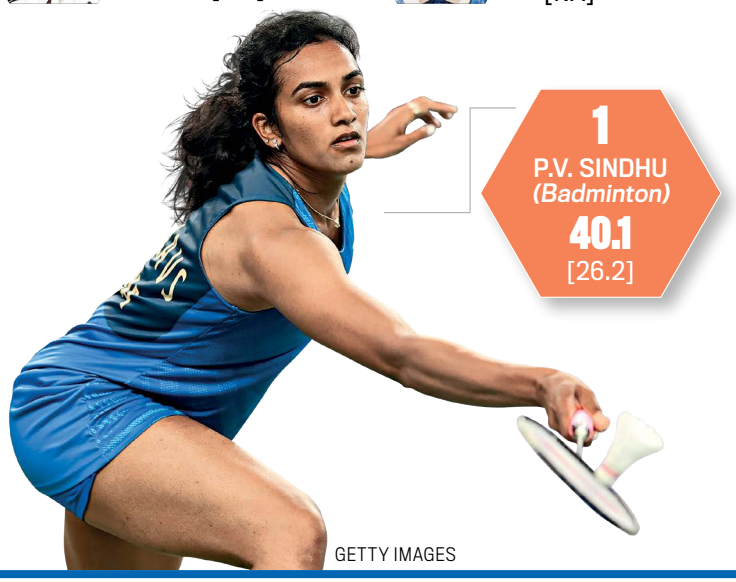
4 SAVITA PUNIA *(Hockey)* **3.2** [6.7]



3 MEERABAI CHANU *(Weightlifting)* **6.8** [6.6]



5 SHEETAL DEVI *(Para archer)* **2.4** [NA]



1 P.V. SINDHU *(Badminton)* **40.1** [26.2]

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All figures in %; rest, others & DK/ CS; Feb. '25 figures in bold, Aug. '24 in [ ]

and weightlifter Meerabai Chanu (No. 3). Sindhu and Chanu fell short of the podium in 2024 but put in inspired performances. Among men, javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra is going strong at the top; the second spot is taken by former football captain Sunil Chhetri, with hockey skipper and two-time Olympic bronze medallist Harmanpreet Singh at No. 4.

In cricket, three of the star batsmen from the T20I World Cup-winning team feature in the poll, with Virat Kohli, despite having a forgettable tour to Australia, again topping the list. Enthusiasm for big hitters was evident in the poll as the charismatic M.S. Dhoni (No. 2), whose power play in the IPL continues to pull crowds to stadiums, Rohit Sharma (No. 3) and newest T20I captain Suryakumar Yadav (No. 5) round up the top five alongside Shubman Gill (No. 4).

While ICC Cricketer of the Year Jasprit Bumrah is surprisingly missing from the top five, it isn't the case for women, where Smriti Mandhana, the ICC ODI Cricketer of the Year of 2024, emerges on top, as she did in August 2024. Mandhana has already beaten Kohli to at least one feat—winning the IPL with Royal Challengers Bengaluru—and she will be hoping to lead the team once again to the title as the third season kicks off. The women's line-up shows some versatility, as apart from batters Shafali Verma and Harmanpreet Kaur, all-rounder Deepti Sharma (No. 4) and spinner Sneh Rana (No. 5) make the cut. ■